

Sales Escalation SOP

Syed Motors · Document Code: SOP-01 · Type: sop · Department: Sales

Purpose

Standard operating procedure for handling customer complaints on the sales floor and escalating them within committed time-frames.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Level 1: Sales Executive

The sales executive who is the point of contact for the customer must acknowledge every complaint within 30 minutes. If the resolution is within their authority (missing accessory, delivery slot change, minor pricing dispute), it must be closed within 24 hours with a written summary to the customer.

The Level 1 stage provides the first response to a customer complaint. The sales executive remains the primary point of contact and should first understand the complaint, identify whether it falls within their authority, and take the appropriate action.

Where the issue can be resolved at Level 1, the written summary provides the customer with a clear record of what was done. The requirement to acknowledge every complaint within 30 minutes is separate from the requirement to close an issue within 24 hours when it is within the executive's authority.

2. Level 2: Sales Manager

Anything requiring a discount, an OEM promise, or a scheduling conflict escalates to the sales manager within 24 hours. The sales manager must contact the customer within four business hours of receiving the escalation.

Level 2 therefore applies when the complaint moves beyond the authority of the sales executive. The sales manager becomes responsible for the next customer contact after the escalation is received.

1. Level 1: Sales Executive - Handling the Initial Complaint

The first stage of the procedure is designed to establish prompt customer acknowledgement and determine whether the issue can be resolved within the sales executive's authority.

Acknowledge. Every complaint must be acknowledged within 30 minutes by the sales executive who is the customer's point of contact. The acknowledgement establishes that the complaint has been received and is being handled.

Understand the issue. The sales executive should establish what the customer is complaining about and determine whether the issue fits within the examples of matters that may be resolved at Level 1.

Resolve when authorised. Missing accessories, delivery slot changes, and minor pricing disputes are examples of issues that may fall within the executive's authority. If the resolution is within that authority, the complaint must be closed within 24 hours.

Provide written closure. A written summary must be provided to the customer when a Level 1 matter is closed. This creates a clear customer-facing record of the resolution.

Moving Beyond Level 1

If the matter requires a discount, an OEM promise, or involves a scheduling conflict, it belongs at Level 2 and must be escalated to the sales manager within 24 hours.

The escalation decision is therefore based on the nature of the complaint and the authority required to resolve it. The sales executive should not treat an issue requiring sales-manager involvement as an ordinary Level 1 closure.

Customer Communication at Level 1

The procedure emphasizes two separate communication points: prompt acknowledgement and written closure. Acknowledgement confirms that the complaint has been received, while the written summary records the outcome when the issue is resolved within the sales executive's authority.

2. Level 2: Sales Manager - Escalated Sales Complaints

Level 2 covers complaints that require sales-manager involvement, including matters requiring a discount, an OEM promise, or resolution of a scheduling conflict.

The sales executive must escalate these matters to the sales manager within 24 hours. Once the sales manager receives the escalation, the sales manager must contact the customer within four business hours.

The two time requirements apply to different stages of the escalation. The first is the period in which the sales executive must pass the matter to the sales manager. The second begins when the sales manager receives the escalation and governs the manager's customer contact.

The sales manager should therefore have enough information from the escalation record to understand what the customer raised and why the matter requires manager-level attention.

3. Level 3: Branch Manager

Financial concessions above PKR 25,000, aggressive customer behaviour, and legal-threat cases escalate to the branch manager. The branch manager engages HR and the legal retainer if warranted.

Level 3 is intended for complaints involving the specified financial threshold or situations that require broader branch-level involvement. Aggressive customer behaviour and legal-threat cases are also identified as Level 3 matters.

The branch manager is the escalation point for these cases. Where warranted, the branch manager engages HR and the legal retainer. This provides a path for matters that extend beyond normal sales-floor complaint handling.

Escalation Boundaries

The three levels create a progression based on authority and case characteristics. Level 1 is handled by the sales executive when the matter is within their authority. Level 2 applies when sales-manager involvement is required. Level 3 applies to the financial, behavioural, and legal situations specifically identified in the procedure.

4. Documentation

Every escalation and its resolution must be logged in the DMS complaint ledger with timestamps, actions taken, and the customer's acknowledgement of closure. Weekly complaint MIS is reviewed by the branch manager on Monday morning.

The DMS complaint ledger is the central record for escalation activity. The record must contain timestamps, the actions taken, and the customer's acknowledgement of closure. These elements allow the escalation history to be followed from the initial complaint through its resolution.

Timestamps. Timestamps establish when actions and escalation events occurred. They are particularly relevant to the time commitments specified at Levels 1 and 2.

Actions taken. The record should show what action was taken during the handling of the complaint. This provides the operational history of the case.

Customer acknowledgement. The customer's acknowledgement of closure records the customer's recognition that the matter has been closed.

Documentation applies to every escalation and its resolution, rather than only to Level 3 cases. The DMS complaint ledger therefore supports the complete escalation process.

Weekly Complaint MIS

The weekly complaint MIS is reviewed by the branch manager on Monday morning. The review provides a recurring management checkpoint for complaint activity and escalation records.

Because escalation records contain timestamps, actions, and closure acknowledgement, the MIS review can be based on the documented history of customer complaints rather than informal recollection.

Relationship Between Escalation and Documentation

Escalation determines who handles a complaint, while documentation records what happened during that handling. Both parts of the SOP work together: the escalation levels define the route, and the DMS complaint ledger preserves the case history.

Sales Complaint Escalation Reference

SOP-01 establishes the complaint-handling route for the Sales department at Syed Motors. The procedure moves complaints through three levels according to the authority or circumstances involved and requires every escalation and resolution to be documented.

Level 1: Sales Executive

The customer-facing sales executive acknowledges every complaint within 30 minutes. Issues within the executive's authority, including missing accessories, delivery slot changes, and minor pricing disputes, must be closed within 24 hours with a written summary to the customer.

Level 2: Sales Manager

Matters requiring a discount, an OEM promise, or involving a scheduling conflict escalate to the sales manager within 24 hours. The sales manager must contact the customer within four business hours of receiving the escalation.

Level 3: Branch Manager

Financial concessions above PKR 25,000, aggressive customer behaviour, and legal-threat cases escalate to the branch manager. The branch manager engages HR and the legal retainer if warranted.

Documentation

Every escalation and its resolution is logged in the DMS complaint ledger with timestamps, actions taken, and the customer's acknowledgement of closure. The branch manager reviews the weekly complaint MIS on Monday morning.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the Sales department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner. Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual.

Quick Reference

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